



Finance Committee Meeting September 5th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbxtA2eEALk
Publication Date	2025-09-10T19:04:41Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Analysis Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No independent preliminary hearing or separate committee work session outside of the regular proceedings was recorded; all business was conducted within the scope of the called meeting.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the second of three working sessions of the Muncie City Council Finance Committee, dedicated to reviewing department heads' proposed 2026 budgets. Note was made that the AV videographer was out ill, so the meeting was recorded via laptop and the audio record was slated to be posted to the Facebook page. [00:00:20](#)
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Council members Macintosh, Basham, Green, Garrett, Selvi (Selby), Golian (Goian), Mason, and Powell. (8 present) [00:03:16](#)
 - **Absent:** Dishman. [00:03:01](#)
 - **Presiding Officer:** Council President / Finance Committee Chair Powell. [00:09:09](#)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance. [00:00:02](#)
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not addressed in this transcript segment).*
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:24](#) **Motion to Suspend Rules and Amend Agenda**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilperson Selvi (seconded by Councilperson Golian).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed adding the Clerk's report, City Council report, and Channel 60 budget to the evening's agenda due to a scheduling conflict for the Clerk.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Yes: Selvi, Golian, Garrett, Macintosh, Basham, Green, Mason, Powell; Absent: Dishman). [00:02:49](#)
- [00:03:40](#) **Clerk's Department Budget Presentation (2025-2026 Budgets)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Clerk Belinda.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The overall budget is lower due to two employees not currently using insurance (a \$42,863.12 reduction). Overtime was reduced by \$1,500 and unemployment by \$1,000. Postage was increased by \$1,000 due to rising certified mail costs (\$10 per envelope) required for the building commissioner's trash/debt collection notices. The Clerk noted state statutory limitations prevent line-item increases after advertising, but proposed exploring internal adjustments via perpetuation fund surpluses in January. Council clarified that state law forbids raising advertised budget line items mid-year without forfeiting tax collection increases.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal budget amendments or line-item increases were adopted. [00:27:37](#)
- [00:27:48](#) **Mayor's Office Budget Presentation (Page 3)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenower.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salary adjustments reflect a standard 4% increase over the salary ordinance. PERS/benefit lines are lower due to the removal of the Deputy Mayor position. Discussion covered the negative long-term impacts of Senate Bill 1 (SB1) levy caps on city staffing by 2028, and a \$900,000 EDIT fund subsidy planned for the general fund. The Mayor confirmed that a \$500,000 allocation for the community center remains fully in play.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review; no formal board action taken. [01:07:27](#)

- **00:37:12 Board of Works Budget Presentation (Page 5)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Health insurance expenses for the general fund were consolidated into the Board of Works budget to simplify claims tracking. Total city health insurance costs are projected to decrease by 13% due to a change in providers with comparable coverage. Discussion ensued regarding traffic signal electricity costs (\$42,000/month), prior federal grant applications for solar fields (\$3.6M grant pulled back by federal actions), and historical local decisions regarding solar energy proposals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review; no formal board action taken.
[01:07:34](#)
- **01:07:38 Personnel Department Budget Presentation (Page 6)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Personnel Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salaries reflect a 4% increase applied via the salary ordinance. Discussion regarding a personnel specialist position noted it was filled 6 weeks prior at a starting rate below the maximum salary ordinance pending a 90-day training/performance review. The Employee Assistance Program (EAP) line item was shifted into Board of Works other services and charges.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review; no formal board action taken.
[01:17:10](#)
- **01:17:19 Fire Department Budgets (General Fund - Page 11, LIT Fund 105 - Page 18, and EMS Fund)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fire Chief and administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salaries and holiday pay across multiple funds were restructured and consolidated into the general fund and LIT funds to streamline tracking. Chief/Deputy Chief salaries factor in longevity and standard contractual adjustments. Overtime lines reflect high demands due to minimum staffing mandates and operating EMS transport without an increase in base headcount. Health insurance costs and PERF allocations were reviewed.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review; no formal board action taken.
[01:46:05](#)

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No open public forum was conducted during this working session, as the presiding officer explicitly noted at [00:01:26](#) that working sessions are held strictly for gathering administrative information and do not include public comment.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Reminder of upcoming budget review opportunities, including the September 8th public hearing and regular council meetings, the September 23rd finance committee meeting, and the October 6th adoption meeting. [00:01:30](#)
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by motion and second following the conclusion of the fire department budget review. [01:46:14](#)

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-26 02:03:57 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.